

PROPOSAL

UNIVERSITY VENUE BOOKING SYSTEM

Prepared for Staff Review

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1. INTRODUCTION

This proposal introduces the University Venue Booking System, a digital platform developed for Mzumbe University to manage the reservation of lecture halls, laboratories, seminar rooms, and other campus venues across all four campuses — Morogoro Main, Dar es Salaam, Tanga, and Mbeya. The system is presented here for staff review and feedback before wider adoption.

2. BACKGROUND & PROBLEM STATEMENT

Venue booking at the University has traditionally been handled through informal, first-come arrangements between Class Representatives, Staff, and campus administration. This approach has often led to double-bookings, clashes with the official teaching timetable, and unnecessary delays in confirming a venue for a class, meeting, or activity. There has been no single, reliable record of what is booked, by whom, and for how long.

3. OBJECTIVES

1. To provide one authoritative record of every venue booking, checked automatically against the official teaching timetable so a booking can never clash with a scheduled class.
2. To let Class Representatives and Staff book a free venue in minutes, without needing to manually consult an Admin for every request.
3. To give Administrators clear tools to manage venues, the timetable, accounts, and bookings that genuinely need a human decision.
4. To keep each campus's data — venues, timetable, bookings, and people — isolated from the others, while still allowing university-wide oversight where needed.

4. WHO USES THE SYSTEM

Role	Description
Class Representative (CR)	Registers and books venues on behalf of their class, on their own campus.
Staff	Registers separately from CRs and books venues for meetings, invigilation, and other official duties.
Admin	Manages venues, the timetable, bookings, and accounts for one campus.
Staff Admin	An Admin scoped only to Staff accounts and Staff-related activity, kept separate from CR/student data.
Super Admin / Super Staff Admin	Oversees all four campuses within their respective domain (general or Staff), and manages other Admin accounts.

Every new CR or Staff account must first be approved by an Admin before it can be used to log in, so account creation is never fully automatic.

5. KEY FEATURES

- Automatic conflict checking against the official teaching timetable for every booking.
 - Separate, approval-gated registration for both Class Representatives and Staff.
 - Digital signature capture to confirm every booking.
- A review queue for bookings that need an Admin's decision, with instant notifications once a decision is made.
 - Campus-scoped venue, timetable, and account management for every Admin.
 - A dedicated Staff Admin track, kept fully separate from student/CR data.
- Announcements and a scrolling marquee banner, targetable to CRs, Staff, or fellow Admins.
- Configurable registration windows — an Admin may open or close CR or Staff self-registration per campus, either immediately or on a scheduled date and time.
- A Maintenance Mode switch, so an Admin can inform ordinary users the system is temporarily unavailable, while Admin access remains unaffected.
- A campus-wide account suspension tool, for temporarily locking out CR or Staff accounts on one campus during an operational issue, fully reversible.
- Installable as a Progressive Web App and as a native Android application, usable offline for previously viewed data.

6. CURRENT STATUS

The system is fully built and deployed, and is available for review at the link below. Staff are encouraged to explore the system, register an account, and try booking a venue, then share any feedback, questions, or concerns before a wider rollout is planned.

<https://tafutavenue-web.vercel.app>

7. COMPANION DOCUMENTS

Two additional manuals accompany this proposal: a User Manual, covering registration and booking for Class Representatives and Staff, and an Admin Manual, covering venue, account, and system management for Administrators.

8. REQUEST FOR REVIEW

Staff are kindly requested to review this proposal and the live system, and to provide feedback on its suitability for adoption across all campuses.